

Fraudulent Account Dispute (Identity Theft)

How to Use this Template

Use when an account was opened in your name without your knowledge or consent (identity theft).

Before sending: replace all bracketed placeholders [] with your details, keep a copy for your records, and send by a method that provides proof of delivery (e.g., registered mail or a tracked courier). Canadian consumer reporting and collection agency laws are set primarily at the provincial/territorial level, so confirm the specific rules and timelines (often around 30 days for investigations) that apply where you live before relying on any deadline stated here.

General mailing addresses for the two major Canadian credit bureaus:

Equifax Canada Co.

Consumer Relations Department
P.O. Box 190, Station Jean-Talon
Montreal, QC H1S 2Z2

TransUnion Canada

Consumer Relations Department
P.O. Box 338, LCD 1
Hamilton, ON L8L 7W2



Governing Canadian Laws & Regulators

- Provincial/Territorial Consumer Reporting Act (e.g., Ontario Consumer Reporting Act, R.S.O. 1990, c. C.33; British Columbia's Personal Information Protection Act also applies to credit reporting; Quebec's Act Respecting the Protection of Personal Information in the Private Sector and the Act respecting the protection of personal information in the private sector, as amended by Law 25) – sets out the consumer's right to dispute file contents and the agency's duty to reinvestigate, typically within 30 days.
- Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA) – federal law giving individuals the right to access and request correction of personal information held by organizations, including credit bureaus, for matters not covered by substantially similar provincial legislation.
- Equifax Canada and TransUnion Canada each maintain internal dispute-resolution processes required under the above legislation; a refusal to correct can be escalated to the applicable provincial Information and Privacy Commissioner or the federal Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada (OPC).

[Your Full Name]

[Your Street Address]
[City, Province, Postal Code]

[Date]

[Recipient Name / Credit Bureau or Creditor Name]
[Department, e.g., Consumer Relations / Disputes Department]
[Street Address]
[City, Province, Postal Code]

RE: Fraudulent Account Dispute – Identity Theft – Account #[Account Number]

Dear [Equifax / TransUnion],

I am a victim of identity theft. I did not open, authorize, or benefit from the account referenced above, and I am formally disputing this account as fraudulent.

Details of the fraudulent account:

- Creditor/Institution name: [Name]
- Account number: [Account Number]
- Date the account was reportedly opened: [Date]
- I first became aware of this fraudulent account on: [Date]

I have reported this incident to the Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre and to my local police service, and a report number is provided below for your reference. I request that you immediately place a fraud alert on my file, block or remove this fraudulent account from my credit report, and cease any further collection or reporting activity related to it pending investigation.

Please conduct a full investigation as required under the applicable provincial Consumer Reporting Act and provide written confirmation once the fraudulent account has been removed. I also request written confirmation of any information disclosed to third parties regarding this account so that I may notify them of the error.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature (if mailing a hard copy)]
[Your Printed Name]

Enclosures:

- Copy of government-issued photo ID
- Police report number / Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre reference number

- Identity Theft Statement / Affidavit (if completed)
- Copy of the credit report page showing the fraudulent account